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Energy Majors and E&Ps | North America

Exploring 2027 Plans: Growth, Costs, & Efficiencies

Oil E&Ps reported solid results over last two weeks, beating cons cash flow by 4% on avg while prod'n & capex came in 2% better, with some slight increases to '26 volumes and spending. Prelim '27 plans suggest low growth, supported by efficiencies, with inflation a key question mark.

Key Takeaways

- Our oil-focused coverage has now reported 3Q results. On average, the group beat consensus production by 1%, cash flow by 5%, with capex 1% lower
- Several tweaked '26 volume guides higher on efficiencies & base prod'n improvements,+1.6% avg, with some adjusting capex, +2.6% avg for those making changes
- Preliminary '27 plans suggest modest oil growth for XOM, COP, FANG, DVN, EOG, MTDR, MUR, OXY with higher capex for APA, EOG, FANG, MUR, OXY
- Oil producers are pricing in long-run WTI of ~$69/bbl, down from ~$74/bbl two weeks ago, while gas E&Ps imply HH of ~$3.55/MMBtu, similar to pre-earnings levels
- Beyond the quarter we retain our defensive bias after YTD strength in oil-exposed names, including a preference for Majors and E&Ps with positive rate of change

Efficiency gains support modest guidance raises. Following results from gas producers (see recap *here*) and Integrateds (see *XOM* & *CVX*) earlier during reported season, our oil E&P coverage wrapped up 3Q results over the past week. On average, oil E&Ps reported production 2% above consensus (+1% for oil only), with capex 2% below and cash flow 4% ahead. Efficiency gains, including some pockets of well outperformance, and base production optimization supported several slight increases to 2026 volume outlooks (+0.2% for oil and ~1.5% for total production, on average), while efficiency-driven activity acceleration and higher infrastructure spending prompted some companies to raise budgets, but only modestly (+2.6% on average, for those that made changes). Commentary pointed to higher consumables costs, though efficiencies have largely offset these pressures year to date. With lingering upside & downside risks for crude, we would continue to use periods of further oil strength to rotate more defensively across the sector.

2027 messaging in focus. Companies generally offered less definitive preliminary plans for the year ahead, compared to 3Q results cycles over the last few years, reflecting lingering uncertainty around commodity prices and service costs. Within the Majors, XOM & COP both continue to expect y/y shale growth into 2027, led by the Permian and consistent with previously disclosed multi-year plans. Across shale

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operators, **FANG, DVN, EOG, OXY,** and **MTDR** all signaled the potential for modest growth into next year, supported by efficiencies. **MUR** plans to increase Eagle Ford activity to help fund exploration in Côte d'Ivoire. **APA, EOG, OXY, FANG** and **MUR** indicated higher spending on exploration, infrastructure and/or some pressure from inflation. Cost commentary generally pointed to mid-single-digit inflation so far this year, largely offset by efficiencies, but with some risks of further cost pressure possible if oil prices remain elevated. See *Guidance Updates & Preliminary 2027 Messaging* for more details.

Key takeaways on preliminary 2027 outlooks:

- **Oil E&Ps:**
  - **APA** expects '27 capex of ~$2.5 B (assumes mid-single-digit Permian inflation) supporting broadly flat US/Egypt production vs '26, with exploration and GranMorgu driving ~60% of the ~$400 MM y/y increase.
  - **CHRD** sees visibility to sustaining oil production ~162.5 kb/d in 2027 (flat with 2026 guidance midpoint), with a 1Q dip followed by a recovery as the second frac crew returns in late 2026 - early 2027.
  - **DVN** targets 1-3% oil and 2-4% total production growth in 2027 on ~$5.3 B of capex, excluding Eagle Ford, with ~75% allocated to the Permian. It raised FY27 synergy capture to ~$700 MM from ~$600 MM.
  - **EOG** continues to signal low-single-digit oil growth in 2027 if fundamentals remain supportive, with activity near the 4Q26 run rate and incremental ~$200 MM of Janus expansion spending. EOG expects modest service inflation and higher steel/diesel costs next year, though efficiencies could be a potential offset.
  - **FANG**'s 2027 base case assumes 19-20 rigs and five frac crews, supporting broadly flat y/y completed footage. Low single digit % growth is a possibility, but dependent on the macro backdrop, and would likely require quarterly capex above the 4Q26 range of $1.00-1.05 B. Management expects some additional service inflation if oil stays elevated.
  - **MTDR** sees potential for mid-single-digit total production growth or better in 2027 at current commodity prices and service costs, similar to plans for 2026, with a focus on prosecuting any growth in an efficient way while also reducing debt.
  - **MUR** expects ~$500 MM of Eagle Ford capex in 2027 (vs ~$300 MM in recent years), driving higher y/y production, with plans to provide separate spending ranges for the base-business and Bubale appraisal in January.
  - **OVV** sees potential for low-single-digit production growth in 2027, with efficiencies and earlier service contracting helping offset inflation. It plans one Logan rig at closing and may add a second during the year.
  - **OXY** sees relatively flat 2027 total production on ~$5.9 B of capex, with higher GoA/international/exploration spending partly offset by lower LCV. Oil volumes should be flat to slightly higher driven by the Permian, with Rockies flat on a boe basis, GOA down (front end loaded injection drilling), and International down (PSC impacts).

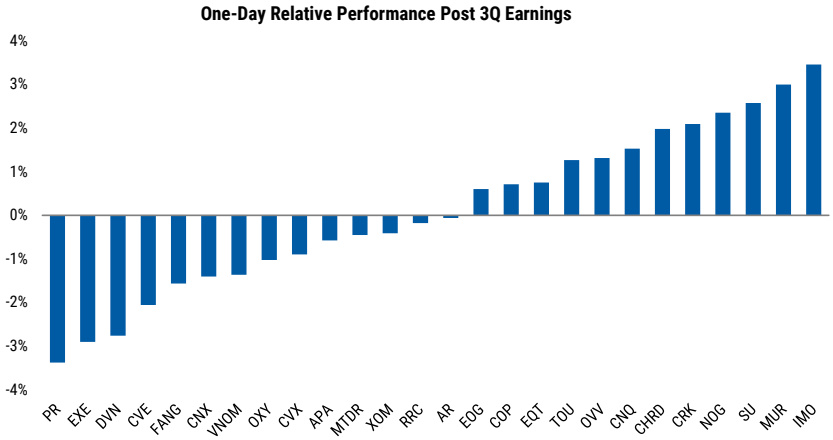
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  - **PR** remains flexible on 2027 growth, aiming to deliver within existing rig and frac crew counts. Operating efficiencies have largely offset diesel inflation.
  - **VNOM** expects continued growth into 2027, supported by FANG development and recent acquisitions, while third-party activity visibility remains limited.
- **Gas E&Ps** posted roughly in-line production and mixed messaging on spending & growth. In total, 4Q26 guidance for our gas coverage implies roughly flat production compared to 3Q actuals, including planned curtailments. In terms of specific updates, **EQT** lowered its 2026 capex guidance by 2% while maintaining its full-year production outlook, with the 4Q guide reflecting planned curtailments. **EXE** maintained its 2026 production midpoint but raised capex guidance by 5%, driven by inflation and leasehold spending, while emphasizing production flexibility in a weak gas market. **AR** trimmed its 4Q production outlook amid weak regional pricing, reflecting curtailments, but is advancing plans for high-single-digit y/y growth in 2027. **CNX** remains in maintenance mode. **CRK** issued 4Q production guidance 7% above cons. with capex 20% below as it returns to 1H24 run-rate production levels, with a recently announced JV with Jerry Jones helping reduce capex near-term. Meanwhile, **RRC** delivered solid operating results, with EQT planning to maintain its existing growth trajectory through 2027.
- **US majors** posted 3Q cash flow beats driven by refining outperformance (**CVX**, **XOM**) and oil/gas realizations (**COP**). Each company's multi-year growth plans remain on track. **XOM**'s expected 4Q Middle East impact is in-line with 3Q (~350 kboe/d), while **COP** still expects significant operational uncertainty in Qatar. **CVX** has minimal exposure to the region. On shareholder returns, **COP** had a large dividend increase (+11%) and expects higher buybacks q/q, consistent with full year targeted payout of 45% of CFO, **CVX** left its repurchase rate unchanged q/q, and **XOM** extended its $20 B buyback pace to 2027 (flat y/y). **CVX** and **XOM** now plan to disclose their 2027 budgets later this year (**XOM** will also provide production guidance). At its Upstream Spotlight in late 2024, XOM messaged a Permian output target of ~2.0 mboe/d in 2027 (vs ~1.8 mboe/d 2026 guide).
- **Canadians** reported solid cash flow beats, supported by strong downstream results (**CVE**, **IMO**, **SU**). **CNQ** also outperformed with stronger liquids volumes. Consolidated production guidance was generally unchanged: **IMO** remains near the low end, with Kearl guidance lowered, while **CVE** expects the high end on strong thermal performance and turnaround execution, though capex should also be at or slightly above the high end. Shareholder return updates were positive, with **IMO** signaling a potential SIB (substantial issuer bid) early next year, **SU** announcing a large dividend increase, and **CNQ** reaching its net debt target ahead of expectations. We expect 2027 capex guidance in December, consistent with prior years.

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Exhibit 1: Guidance updates and 2027 outlooks drove wide dispersion across our coverage. DVN lagged amid debate over portfolio strategy, while higher spending expectations weighed on EXE.



Source: FactSet, Morgan Stanley Research. Note: Relative one-day performance calculated vs respective peer group average (gas E&Ps, oil E&Ps, Canadian integrateds).

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Guidance Updates & Preliminary 2027 Messaging

Oil-focused Operators

- **APA** raised 2026 upstream capex by $30 MM to ~$2.1 B on faster drilling times enabling to accelerate Permian completions, while increasing FY26 US oil guidance from 123 kb/d to ~124 kb/d. APA's preliminary 2027 capex estimate is ~$2.5 B (~$400 MM higher y/y), with exploration and GranMorgu accounting for ~60% of the increase and the remainder reflecting higher Permian activity and mid-single-digit US inflation. APA plans to increase Permian rigs from four to six around YE26, targeting a greater Delaware weighting of ~40% over the next few years (vs ~15% in 2026). On production, APA expects 2027 US and Egypt output to remain broadly flat y/y, while GranMorgu remains on schedule for first oil in mid-2028. Exploration plans include two Suriname wells in 2027, Alaska's Chinook exploration well and Sockeye appraisal this winter, and Uruguay's OFF-6 well with Eni in late 2027.
- **CHRD** raised 2026 oil guidance ~1% to 162-163 kb/d and increased capex ~$60 MM to $1,435-1,485 MM, reflecting ~$20 MM of additional midstream spending and higher op and non-op activity. After dropping its second frac crew in July, CHRD expects production to decline sequentially in 4Q26 and in 1Q27, before recovering in 2Q27 as the crew returns in late 2026 or early 2027. For 2027, management sees visibility to sustaining oil near the higher ~162.5 kb/d baseline, supported by improvements in base production. Year-to-date, CHRD has offset low-to-mid-single-digit inflation with efficiencies, including ~9% lower drilling costs on four-mile wells since 1Q26 and >20% higher frac productivity vs 2025. Separately, marketing agreements signed YTD are expected to generate $35-55 MM of incremental annualized FCF savings over time, while the previously announced $550 MM Marcellus divestiture remains on track to close in 4Q26.
- **CNQ** left 2026 guidance for production (1,637–1,682 kboe/d) and capex ex-acquisitions (~C$6,115 MM) unchanged. Production in 2027 should benefit from a full year of contributions from this year's Peace River acquisitions (40-50 kboe/d run rate volumes) and no planned Horizon turnaround, versus 28 days of downtime in 2026. Similar to prior years, we expect CNQ to announce its 2027 guidance with a standalone press release in mid-December.
- **COP** reiterated its 2026 guidance including capex of $12.0-$12.5 B and total production of 2,295-2,325 kboe/d. Management provided initial 2027 messaging that was consistent with COP's multi-year FCF outlook. The company expects capital spending to decline modestly y/y while still delivering low-single-digit underlying production growth, driven by steady-state Lower 48 activity. Unit operating costs should decline again as structural cost reductions and efficiency gains offset inflation. See more *here*.
- **CVE** expects FY26 total production to be towards the top end of the guidance range (970-1,010 kboe/d) with oil sands operations continuing to outperform and following the Christina Lake turnaround optimization. Capex is also trending to the top end of guidance (C$5.0-C$5.3 B) or slightly above due to longer duration of capitalizing West White Rose costs, FX impacts in the downstream (weakened

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Canadian dollar), and modest increases in growth capital in Upstream in the back half of the year. For next year, production should be positively impacted y/y from ramp-up of West White Rose (delivery imminent with peak net production previously guided to ~45 kb/d in 2028) and Athabasca Oil volumes (~45 kboe/d 2026 exit rate). CVE had previously messaged 2027 capex close to 2026 spending levels, though next year's budget will now also include C$700-C$800 MM of spend for ATH.

- **CVX** made no change to its 2026 total production guidance range of 3,980-4,100 kboe/d and still expects to be at the low end of its capex plans ($18-$19 B), which with $12.6 B spent YTD, implies a large step-up in spending in 4Q. Turning to next year, CVX plans to disclose its 2027 capital budget in December where we expect capex guidance to be in-line with its long-term outlook ($18-$21 B in 2026-30), though affiliate spending could come in at the high end of the range ($1-$2 B) due to inclusion of Venezuela. Production guidance, which would likely be issued early next year, should be in-line with the company's multi-year outlook issued with last year's investor day (2-3% CAGR from 2025-30) and include flat US shale volumes of ~1.6 mboe/d. See more *here*.
- **DVN** maintained 2026 oil guidance of 495-505 kb/d and capex of $4.8-$5.0 B, with 4Q oil flat q/q on lower spending. Its initial 2027 outlook targets ~525 kb/d of oil and ~1,600 kboe/d total on ~$5.3 B of capex, implying 1-3% oil and 2-4% total volume growth on a full-year combined basis excluding Eagle Ford. The Permian will receive ~75% of capital, up from ~63% in 2026. In addition, DVN plans to invest ~$500 MM for ground game and ~$400 MM for Solitude. FY27 synergies rise to ~$700 MM from ~$600 MM, with the ≥$1 B annual pre-tax target by YE27 unchanged. The portfolio review reaffirmed the Permian as its cornerstone, with complementary basins providing FCF and growth optionality. Eagle Ford proceeds will fund debt reduction and larger buybacks, with >$1 B of repurchases planned in 4Q26 and further acceleration in 2027. See *here*.
- **EOG** maintained 2026 capex while raising total production guidance by +0.6% at midpoint to 1,393.2-1,425.0 kboe/d and oil +0.1% to 547.3-551.7 kb/d, despite non-core Barnett/Woodford divestitures in Sept-Oct that contributed ~16 kboe/d (~2 kb/d oil) in 3Q. For 2027, management continues to signal low-single-digit oil growth if oil fundamentals remain supportive, with activity broadly consistent with 4Q26 and ~$200 MM of incremental spending from the Janus plant expansion (~$300 MM total). On 2027 cost trends, management expects modest D&C service inflation and higher steel/diesel prices, but typical annual efficiency gains of ~3-5% expected to provide a potential offset. EOG has contracted ~60% of services and secured half of its casing/tubular needs for 2027, while staggered renewals, direct sourcing and gas-powered equipment (~70% of rigs and 100% of frac fleets) should further mitigate inflation. Separately, EOG announced a new 10-year gas sales agreement with ENGIE for 140,000 MMBtu/d at JKM-linked pricing, starting by 2030.
- **FANG** raised 2026 oil production guidance to ~524 kb/d from 522+ kb/d and capex to ~$3.95-4.00 B from ~$3.9 B, reflecting a ~1.5% increase in expected net completed lateral footage to 6.2-6.6 MM ft. For 2027, management's current base case assumes a level-loaded program of 19-20 rigs and five frac crews, with completed footage broadly flat y/y. Management indicated that pursuing growth next year, should they opt to do so, would likely require a quarterly capex above

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the 4Q26 range of $1.00-1.05 B. On inflation, FANG expects higher service-cost pressure if oil remains at ~$100/bbl but plans to mitigate it through efficiencies. In the Barnett, FANG is moving from delineation toward full-field development, with 2027 obligation drilling expected to be integrated into high-return development areas.

- **MTDR** raised 2026 total production guidance by ~2.5 kboe/d at midpoint to 223-224 kboe/d (and oil by 0.75 kb/d to 128.75-129.25 kb/d), reflecting 3Q outperformance and an improved 4Q outlook. MTDR maintained FY26 DC&E capex midpoint of $1,520 MM, while Marlan plant expansion increases midstream capex ~$25 MM to ~$180 MM and total capex to ~$1.70 B. MTDR continues to expect 2026 D&C costs of $785-805/ft despite service inflation, supported by faster drilling, simulfrac/trimulfrac, recycled water and field-gas use. For 2027, management sees potential for mid-single-digit total production growth or better at current commodity prices and service costs. Separately, San Mateo's newly announced third-party agreements support a 300 mmcf/d Marlan expansion, with management expecting combined midstream EBITDA to approach $400 MM in 2026, +17% y/y.
- **MUR** raised 2026 production guidance ~6 kboe/d at midpoint to 176-178 kboe/d at unchanged $1.5-1.6 B capex, primarily reflecting lower Tupper Montney royalties and Eagle Ford outperformance. For 2027, MUR messaged Eagle Ford capex of ~ $500 MM (vs ~$300 MM in recent years) to support materially higher y/y production, ramping through 4Q27, as part of a multiyear increase toward a new plateau. MUR expects to provide separate guidance for base business capex and Bubale appraisal spending in January, reflecting uncertainty around well count. The company expects to resume appraisal at Bubale in ~2Q27, subject to rig availability, at ~$80-100 MM/well, potentially ~$110 MM with extensive evaluation. MUR plans to allocate ~10-15% of 2027 capex to exploration, with potential drilling at one hub-scale GoA prospect and tieback opportunities near Lac Da Vang in Vietnam, including Lac Duong in 2027-28.
- **OVV** maintained 2026 oil & condensate guidance of 210-212 kb/d and capex of $2.25-2.35 B. Its 4Q oil & condensate outlook implies broadly flat production versus 3Q and assumes the Albright plant outage persists through year-end. OVV shifted ~$50 MM from the Montney to the Permian to mitigate the disruption. Management sees low-single-digit production growth in 2027, with efficiencies and earlier service contracting helping mitigate inflation. OVV plans to deploy one rig on the Logan acreage at closing in early 1Q27 and will evaluate adding a second during 2027. It reiterated plans to return 60%+ of FY26 FCF to shareholders, implying another strong quarter of buybacks in 4Q.
- **OXY**'s implied 2026 production is broadly unchanged, with oil ~2% below the prior midpoint and capex steady at ~$5.7 B. US well cost savings are tracking above 7% versus 2025, while simulfrac utilization is expected to exceed 60% by year-end versus >45% for FY26, with 2027 capturing a full year of both benefits. Its preliminary 2027 outlook points to relatively flat total production on ~$5.9 B of capex, with broadly flat US onshore spending, higher GoA, international and exploration investment, and lower LCV spending. OXY achieved its $10 B debt target and set a new $6 B milestone. It will resume opportunistic repurchases once the balance sheet is in net-cash position (potentially in 2027).
- **PR** raised full-year oil guidance by ~2% at the midpoint to 201-204 kb/d, driven by

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strong well and base performance, higher working interests and increased workovers. It increased capex by ~4% to $1.975-2.075 B, including ~$20 MM for Ridge Runner. PR expects >210 kb/d of oil in 4Q, including ~4 kb/d from the acquisition, while holding spending broadly flat sequentially at ~$520 MM. Since 2Q updates, PR completed ~$1.15 B of acquisitions across ~175 transactions, adding ~24k net acres and ~200 net locations. Operating efficiencies have largely mitigated diesel inflation. Management remains flexible on 2027 growth and aims to deliver within existing rig and frac crew counts.

- **VNOM** raised FY26 oil production guidance by ~1% at midpoint to 67.25-67.75 kb/d and total boe by ~3% to 137-138 kboe/d, reflecting strong activity from FANG and third-party operators, the September FANG dropdown & McElroy Ranch acquisitions, and the pending Buckhorn deal (to close in 4Q26). Management expects continued production growth into 2027, with FANG activity a key driver, while noting limited visibility into third-party development at this point. VNOM repurchased $90 MM of Class A shares in 3Q and $17 MM in 4Q-to-date, while continuing to retain significant cash for debt repayment following recent M&A.
- **IMO** lowered its FY26 Kearl target to 280 kb/d gross (199 kb/d net) from 285–295 kb/d due to YTD third-party impacts. Cold Lake and Syncrude remain on track for the low end of guidance, while no formal change was made to the consolidated range of 441–460 kboe/d. For next year, production should grow in accordance with previously guided multi-year targets at Cold Lake and Kearl. Kearl will also benefit from having no planned turnarounds next year and improved ore quality from entering the East Pit. IMO's 2025 Investor Day plan implies roughly C$1.8-C $1.9 B of 2027 capex (see *here*).
- **NOG** increased its total production guidance range from 143 - 148 Mboe/d to 147 - 150 Mboe/d driven by record gas volumes. Oil production guide tightens by 0.25 Mbbl/d at the low end to 71.750 - 73.5 Mbbl/d and capex guidance holds steady at $850 - 900 MM, although management noted that current activity levels could push the full-year figure towards the high end of this range. While management has not formally issued guidance on 2027, this year's spending could support flattish production y/y or slightly better.
- **SU**'s 2027 production should broadly track the multi-year growth profile laid out at its investor day earlier this year, adjusted for the offshore asset divestment (expected to close in early 2027), which removes ~18 kb/d based on 1H26 volumes. The divestment cuts planned upstream growth by 2028 (vs 2025) from 100 kb/d to ~60 kb/d, though management kept its free funds flow and breakeven targets unchanged. Also consistent with investor day, 2027 capex should be C$6B or less, possibly lower if some 2027 spend is pulled into 2026. Formal 2027 guidance is due in December.
- At the start of this year, **XOM** guided to total production growing from ~4.9 mboe/d in 2026 to ~5.5 mboe/d in 2030. The 2026 guidance though excludes Middle East impacts of about ~360 kboe/d for FY26 by our estimates. Additionally, XOM's Middle East production will also continue to be negatively impacted by two damaged LNG trains in Qatar on a go-forward basis by about ~100 kboe/d atleast through 2027. Lastly on production, XOM previously messaged Permian output of ~2.0 mboe/d in 2027 (vs ~1.8 mboe/d 2026 guide), though this was last affirmed with the 2024 Upstream Spotlight nearly two years ago. On capital spending, XOM currently guides to annual cash capex of $28-$32 B from 2027-30. The company

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plans to disclose a full 2027 outlook later this year via a press release, rather than a Corporate Plan Update call. See more *here*.

Gas Producers

- **AR** reduced its 4Q production outlook from 4.4 - 4.5 Bcfe/d to 4.3 Bcfe/d with 3Q26 earnings as it now includes 15-20 Bcfe of curtailments driven by weak regional pricing. Management adjusted full-year 2026 spending to reflect its growth plans (+$200 MM 2026 spend for high single digit y/y production growth for 2027). This is consistent with prior messaging but wasn't fully reflected in consensus capex estimates. Cost reductions were in focus as AR expects to achieve $140 MM of its YE28 $300 MM margin enhancement target by mid-2027. During 3Q, AR optimized 400 MMcf/d of firm transport (+$20 MM annualized FCF) and is commencing a formal process in 4Q to optimize >1 bcf/d of natural gas transport (+$50 MM).
- **CNX** messaged expectations for maintenance production mode in 2027 and we expect CNX's elevated hedge levels vs. peers supporting buybacks into next year. Management as historically messaged maintenance production as 600 - 620 Bcfe and we model the midpoint of 610 Bcfe accordingly.
- **CRK** issued 4Q guidance 7% above consensus as it expects to return to 1H24 production levels, consistent with prior messaging. We forecast mid/low single digit growth y/y into next year, although 4Q27 net volumes should be down vs 4Q26 inclusive of impacts from the SOCAR deal and Jerry Jones JV. The Jones deal should provide $450 MM of capital for wells in the Western Haynesville and CRK expects ⅔ of the contribution to be spent over the last 4 months of 2026 with the remainder to be spent across 1H27. Production impacts from the JV will likely be seen in late 4Q27, but CRK has not provided a specific guide. CRK is currently running 5 rigs in the Western Haynesville with 4 in the legacy Haynesville and plans to upgrade 2 rigs to 10,000 psi capability in 2Q27 while also blending Western Haynesville infill development wells into the program next year.
- **EQT** reported quarterly production 2% below the midpoint of guidance (-4% vs cons.) due to 21 Bcfe of curtailments, while maintaining its full-year volume outlook. Both maintenance and growth capex sat below the low end of guidance in 3Q and management lowered the full-year range by 2%, driven by a reduction in maintenance capital intensity. Prior to earnings, EQT announced its acquisition of RRC, creating a gas "major" with >9 Bcfe/d of pro forma production, +30 years of inventory, and an enterprise value exceeding $50 B. EQT plans to leave RRC's activity unchanged near-term, growing production from 2.4 Bcfe/d in 2026 to 2.6 Bcfe/d in 2027. For more on the acquisition, see *here*.
- **EXE** narrowed 2026 production guidance with the midpoint unchanged, and raised capex by ~5% to ~$3 B, driven by diesel inflation and leasehold acquisitions. Management highlighted flexibility around curtailments and well timing, while flagging low- to mid-single-digit cost inflation in 2027 and a constructive marketing outlook following the Twin Eagle acquisition. The appointment of Danny Brown as CEO reinforces continuity in EXE's integrated gas strategy, with a focus on continuous improvement and marketing-driven margin expansion. See more *here*.
- **TOU** maintained its 2026 EP capital budget and guided 4Q production to 635-645

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kboe/d, supported by Aitken's start-up, new wells and storage withdrawals. It raised expected exit production to ≥670 kboe/d from ~660 kboe/d. For 2027, TOU lowered its production outlook to 645-665 kboe/d from 665 kboe/d and raised EP spending by C$50 MM to C$2.6 B. Management cited greater ethane rejection behind the volume change, while the spending increase provides for potential inflation. Groundbirch remains on track for 4Q27. TOU will allocate excess FCF across base dividend increases, buybacks and potential special dividends. Management currently favors repurchases and plans further purchases in November and December.

Exhibit 2: Preliminary 2027 Production

	Production Tracker			
	2026 Guidance	Implied 2027 Production	2027 MSe	2027 Consensus
Oil E&Ps				
APA	US & Egypt: 410 kboe/d (oil 200 kb/d)	US & Egypt: 410 kboe/d (oil 200 kb/d)	US & Egypt: 408 kboe/d (oil 198 kb/d)	436 kboe/d (oil 215 kb/d)
COP	2,295 - 2,325 kboe/d (oil 1216 - 1232 kb/d)	N/A	2,406 kboe/d	2,406 kboe/d
CHRD	280.9 - 282.7 kboe/d (oil 162 - 163 kb/d)	oil 162.5 kb/d	264 kboe/d (oil 161 kb/d)	262 kboe/d (oil 160 kb/d)
DVN	1,364 - 1,398 kboe/d (oil 495 - 505 kb/d)	~1,600 kboe/d (~525 kb/d oil)	1,604 kboe/d (oil 526 kb/d)	1,622 kboe/d (oil 529 kb/d)
EOG	1,393.2 - 1,425.0 kboe/d (oil 547.3 - 551.7 kb/d)	oil ~560 kb/d	1,447 kboe/d (oil 562 kb/d)	1,452 kboe/d (oil 560 kb/d)
FANG	~1,015 kboe/d (oil ~524 kb/d)	oil ~534 kb/d	1,022 kboe/d (oil 531 kb/d)	1,047 kboe/d (oil 532 kb/d)
OVV	630 - 645 kboe/d (oil & condensate 210 - 212 kb/d)	~215-216 kb/d oil & condensate	oil & condensate 217 kb/d	oil & condensate 216 kb/d
OXY	1,429 - 1,439 kboe/d (oil 705 - 710 kb/d)	~1,434 kboe/d	1,441 kboe/d (oil 725 kb/d)	1,465 kboe/d (oil 727 kb/d)
PR	415 - 445 kboe/d (oil 201 - 204 kb/d)	N/A	438 kboe/d (oil 208 kb/d)	460 kboe/d (oil 211 kb/d)
MTDR	223 - 224 kboe/d (oil 128.75 - 129.25 kb/d)	235+ kboe/d	244 kboe/d (oil 137 kb/d)	241 kboe/d (oil 139 kb/d)
MUR	176 - 178 kboe/d (oil ~85 kb/d)	N/A	183 kboe/d (oil 92 kb/d)	186 kboe/d (oil 94 kb/d)
NOG	147 - 150 kboe/d (oil 71.5 - 73.5 kb/d)	N/A	150 kboe/d (oil 75 kb/d)	156 kboe/d (oil 76 kb/d)
Gas E&Ps				
AR	4.13 Bcfe/d	4.5 Bcfe/d	4.5 Bcfe/d	4.5 Bcfe/d
CNX	612.5 - 617.5 Bcfe	600 - 620 Bcfe	1.7 Bcfe/d	1.7 Bcfe/d
CRK	1,260 - 1,290 Mmcfe/d	N/A	1.3 Bcfe/d	1.3 Bcfe/d
EQT	2,375 - 2,450 Bcfe	N/A	2,478 Bcfe	3,133 Bcfe*
EXE	7.45 - 7.55 Bcfe/d	N/A	7.6 Bcfe/d	7.6 Bcfe/d
RRC	2.35 - 2.4 Bcfe/d	~2.6 Bcfe/d	2.6 Bcfe/d	2.6 Bcfe/d
TOU	622 - 625 kboe/d	645 - 665 kboe/d	663 kboe/d	657 kboe/d

Source: Company data, Visible Alpha, FactSet, Bloomberg, Morgan Stanley Research. Note: OVV assumes ~2% oil & condensate growth from the 2H26 baseline, consistent with management's low-single-digit growth commentary, plus ~7 kb/d from Logan Energy. OXY assumes flat y/y total production based on management commentary. EQT MSe does not reflect the pending RRC acquisition and may not be comparable to consensus. CVE MSe does not reflect the pending ATH acquisition and may not be comparable to consensus. EOG and FANG assume 2% y/y oil growth. MTDR assumes 5% total production growth.

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Exhibit 3: Preliminary 2027 Capex

	Capex Tracker			
	2026 Guidance	Implied 2027 Capex	2027 MSe	2027 Consensus
Oil E&Ps				
APA	$2.1 B	$2.5 B	$2.5 B	$2.6 B
COP	$12.0-12.5 B	N/A	$12.04 B	$12. B
CHRD	$1,435 - $1,485 MM	N/A	$1,454 MM	$1,432 MM
DVN	$4.8 - $5.0 B	~$5.3 B	$5.3 B	$5.4 B
EOG	$6.3 - 6.7 B	$6.7+ B	$6.7 B	$6.7 B
FANG	$3.95 - $4.0 B	$4.2+ B	$4.2 B	$4.2 B
OVV	$2.25 - $2.35 B	~$2.5 B	$2.43 B	$2.4 B
OXY	~$5.7 B	~$5.9 B	$5.9 B	$5.9 B
PR	$1.975 - $2.075 B	N/A	$2,018 MM	$2,049 MM
MTDR	$1,670 - $1,730 MM	N/A	$1,737 MM	$1,787 MM
MUR	$1,500 - $1,600 MM	N/A	$1,761 MM	$1,787 MM
NOG	$850 - 900 MM	N/A	$1,060 MM	$1,044 MM
Gas E&Ps				
AR	$1,300 MM	N/A	$1,286 MM	$1,295 MM
CNX	$571 - $586 MM	$600 MM	$611 MM	$592 MM
CRK	$1.242 - $1.342 B	N/A	$1,241 MM	$1,160 MM
EQT	$2.60 - 2.74 B	$2.02 - $2.1 B + Growth	$2.71 B	$3.2 B*
EXE	~$3 B	N/A	$3.0 B	$3.0 B
RRC	$650 - $700 MM	$650 - $700 MM	$687 MM	$692 MM
TOU	C$2.65 B	C$2.75 B	C$2.71 B	C$2.74 B
Integrateds				
CNQ	C$6.12 B	N/A	C$6.5 B	C$6.5 B
CVE	C$5.0 - C$5.3 B	C$6.0 - C$6.1 B	C$5.1 B	C$5.7 B
CVX	$18 - $19 B	$18.0 - $21.0 B	$18.93 B	$18.7 B
IMO	C$2.0 - C$2.2 B	C$1.8 - $1.9 B	C$1.9 B	C$1.9 B
SU	C$5.6 - C$5.8 B	<C$6.0 B	C$5.8 B	C$5.6 B
XOM	$27 - $29 B	$28 - $32 B	$29.3 B	N/A

Source: Company data, Visible Alpha, FactSet, Bloomberg, Morgan Stanley Research. Note: DVN 2027 capex excludes land/ground-game acquisitions and ~$400 MM of Solitude investment. OVV 2027 capex is an illustrative estimate based on ~$2.3 B legacy OVV plus ~$200 MM Logan. EQT MSe does not reflect the pending RRC acquisition and may not be comparable to consensus. CVE MSe does not reflect the pending ATH acquisition and may not be comparable to consensus

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3Q26 Results

Exhibit 4: Oil E&Ps beat consensus cash flow by 4% and production by 2%, with capex 2% below expectations. Gas E&Ps missed cash flow by 2% on in-line production and 4% lower capex. Integrateds beat cash flow by 7%, with capex 2% above consensus.

Company	CFPS	Production	Capex
APA	8%	2%	-9%
COP	5%	0%	1%
CHRD	5%	0%	1%
DVN	2%	1%	4%
EOG	2%	1%	-3%
FANG	3%	2%	1%
MTDR	3%	2%	-12%
MUR	7%	3%	0%
NOG	-3%	3%	-2%
OVV	2%	1%	-1%
OXY	10%	1%	-3%
PR	-2%	2%	3%
Oil E&Ps Average	**4%**	**2%**	**-2%**
AR	-5%	1%	4%
CNX	-11%	1%	-10%
CRK	1%	-1%	-3%
EQT	-3%	-4%	-18%
EXE	4%	1%	6%
RRC	4%	2%	-8%
TOU	-3%	-1%	0%
Gas E&Ps Average	**-2%**	**0%**	**-4%**
XOM	3%	1%	2%
CVX	4%	1%	-14%
IMO	3%	-3%	23%
SU	9%	0%	-8%
CVE	12%	2%	2%
CNQ	10%	1%	6%
Integrateds Average	**7%**	**0%**	2%

Source: Company Data, Bloomberg, Morgan Stanley Research

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Guidance Changes & Shareholder Returns

Exhibit 5: Several oil E&Ps modestly raised 2026 production guidance, while gas producer updates were mixed and integrateds held outlooks unchanged.

	Prior 2026 Guidance	New 2026 Guidance	% Change	2026 Consensus
Oil E&Ps				
APA	429 kboe/d (adj. oil 179 kb/d)	434 kboe/d (adj. oil 180 kb/d)	+1.2% (adj. oil +0.6%)	433 kboe/d
COP	2,295 - 2,325 kboe/d (oil 1216 - 1232 kb/d)	2,295 - 2,325 kboe/d (oil 1216 - 1232 kb/d)	0% (oil 0%)	2,302 kboe/d
CHRD	278.2 - 281.8 kboe/d (oil 160.2 - 161.8 kb/d)	280.9 - 282.7 kboe/d (oil 162 - 163 kb/d)	+0.6% (oil +0.9%)	281 kboe/d
DVN	1,364 - 1,398 kboe/d (oil 495 - 505 kb/d)	1,364 - 1,398 kboe/d (oil 495 - 505 kb/d)	0% (oil 0%)	1,389 kboe/d
EOG	1,378.3 - 1,423.1 kboe/d (oil 546.3 - 551.1 kb/d)	1,393.2 - 1,425.0 kboe/d (oil 547.3 - 551.7 kb/d)	+0.6% (oil +0.1%)	1,410 kboe/d
FANG	1,000+ kboe/d (oil 522+ kb/d)	~1,015 kboe/d (oil ~524 kb/d)	+1.5% (oil +0.4%)	1,016 kboe/d
OVV	630 - 645 kboe/d (oil & condensate 210 - 212 kb/d)	630 - 645 kboe/d (oil & condensate 210 - 212 kb/d)	0% (oil & condensate 0%)	oil & condensate 210 kb/d
OXY	1,423 - 1,453 kboe/d (oil 716 - 731 kb/d)	1,429 - 1,439 kboe/d (oil 705 - 710 kb/d)	-0% (oil -2%)	1,436 kboe/d
PR	400 - 430 kboe/d (oil 197 - 201 kb/d)	415 - 445 kboe/d (oil 201 - 204 kb/d)	+4% (oil +2%)	423 kboe/d
MTDR	218.5 - 223.5 kboe/d (oil 127.5 - 129 kb/d)	223 - 224 kboe/d (oil 128.75 - 129.25 kb/d)	+1% (oil +0.6%)	223 kboe/d
MUR	167 - 175 kboe/d (oil 86 kb/d)	176 - 178 kboe/d (oil ~85 kb/d)	+3.5% (oil -1%)	176 kboe/d
NOG	143 - 148 kboe/d (oil 71.5 - 73.5 kb/d)	147 - 150 kboe/d (oil 71.75 - 73.5 kb/d)	+2% (oil +0.2%)	150 kboe/d
Gas E&Ps				
AR	4.15 - 4.2 Bcfe/d	4.13 Bcfe/d	-1%	4.14 Bcfe/d
CNX	605 - 620 Bcfe	612.5 - 617.5 Bcfe	0.4%	617 Bcfe
CRK	1,250 - 1,400 Mmcfe/d	1,260 - 1,290 Mmcfe/d	-4%	1,280 Mmcfe/d
EQT	2,375 - 2,450 Bcfe	2,375 - 2,450 Bcfe	0%	2,446 Bcfe
RRC	2.35 - 2.4 Bcfe/d	2.35 - 2.4 Bcfe/d	0%	2.38 Bcfe/d
EXE	7.4 - 7.6 Bcfe/d	7.45 - 7.55 Bcfe/d	0%	7.49 Bcfe/d
TOU	620 - 640 kboe/d	622 - 625 kboe/d	-1%	624 kboe/d
Integrateds				
CNQ	1,637 - 1,682 kboe/d	1,637 - 1,682 kboe/d	0%	1,667 kboe/d
CVE	970 - 1,010 kboe/d	970 - 1,010 kboe/d	0%	1,002 kboe/d
CVX	3,980 - 4,100 kboe/d	3,980 - 4,100 kboe/d	0%	3,987 kboe/d
IMO	441 - 460 kboe/d	441 - 460 kboe/d	0%	431 kboe/d
SU	840 - 870 kboe/d	840 - 870 kboe/d	0%	849 kboe/d
XOM	~4,900 kboe/d	~4,900 kboe/d	0%	4,526 kboe/d
Royalties & Minerals				
VNOM	132.5 - 135 kboe/d (oil 66 - 67.25 kb/d)	137 - 138 kboe/d (oil 67.25 - 67.75 kb/d)	+3% (oil +1%)	136 kboe/d

Source: Company data, Visible Alpha, FactSet, Bloomberg, Morgan Stanley Research. Note: COP's 2026 oil guidance applies the previously guided oil split of ~53% to the total production guidance range.

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Exhibit 6: Many oil E&Ps held 2026 capex steady, with some producers adjusting budgets higher (+2.6% on average). AR and EXE raised spending by 18% and 5%, although this was consistent with prior messaging for AR, while CRK and EQT lowered budgets by 14% and 2%.

	Prior 2026 Guidance	New 2026 Guidance	% Change	2026 Consensus
Oil E&Ps				
APA	$2.07 B	$2.1 B	+1%	$2.2 B
COP	$12.0-12.5 B	$12.0-12.5 B	0%	$12 B
CHRD	$1,360 - $1,440 MM	$1,435 - $1,485 MM	+4%	$1,418 MM
DVN	$4.8 - $5.0 B	$4.8 - $5.0 B	0%	$5.0 B
EOG	$6.3 - 6.7 B	$6.3 - 6.7 B	0%	$6.6 B
FANG	~$3.9 B	$3.95 - $4.0 B	+2%	$4. B
OVV	$2.25 - $2.35 B	$2.25 - $2.35 B	0%	$2.3 B
OXY	$5.5 - $5.9 B	~$5.7 B	0%	$5.8 B
PR	$1.9 - $2.0 B	$1.975 - $2.075 B	+4%	$2.0 B
MTDR	$1,625 - $1,725 MM	$1,670 - $1,730 MM	+1%	$1,702 MM
MUR	$1,500 - $1,600 MM	$1,500 - $1,600 MM	0%	$1,550 MM
NOG	$850 - 900 MM	$850 - 900 MM	0%	$901 MM
Gas E&Ps				
AR	$1,100 MM	$1,300 MM	18%	$1255 MM
CNX	$556 - $586 MM	$571 - $586 MM	1%	$575 MM
CRK	$1.45 - $1.55 B	$1.242 - $1.342 B	-14%	$1,395 MM
EQT	$2.62 - 2.83 B	$2.60 - 2.74 B	-2%	$2.7 B
RRC	$650 - $700 MM	$650 - $700 MM	0%	$678 MM
EXE	$2.75 - 2.95 B	~$3 B	5%	$3.0 B
TOU	C$2.65 B	C$2.65 B	0%	C$2.31 B
Integrateds				
CNQ	C$6.12 B	C$6.12 B	0%	C$7. B
CVE	C$5.0 - C$5.3 B	C$5.0 - C$5.3 B	0%	C$5.7 B
CVX	$18 - $19 B	$18 - $19 B	0%	N/A
IMO	C$2.0 - C$2.2 B	C$2.0 - C$2.2 B	0%	C$2.11 B
SU	C$5.6 - C$5.8 B	C$5.6 - C$5.8 B	0%	C$5.6 B
XOM	$27 - $29 B	$27 - $29 B	0%	N/A

Source: Company data, Visible Alpha, FactSet, Bloomberg, Morgan Stanley Research. CNQ guidance shown excludes net acquisition capital. EQT guide includes maintenance + growth spend.

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Exhibit 7: DVN plans >$1 B of 4Q buybacks and further acceleration in 2027. For integrateds, IMO messaged a potential SIB (substantial issuer bid) early next year, CNQ moved to a 100% FCF payout, and XOM extended its $20 B annual buyback pace through 2027. COP, EOG, FANG, SU and TOU all raised dividends.

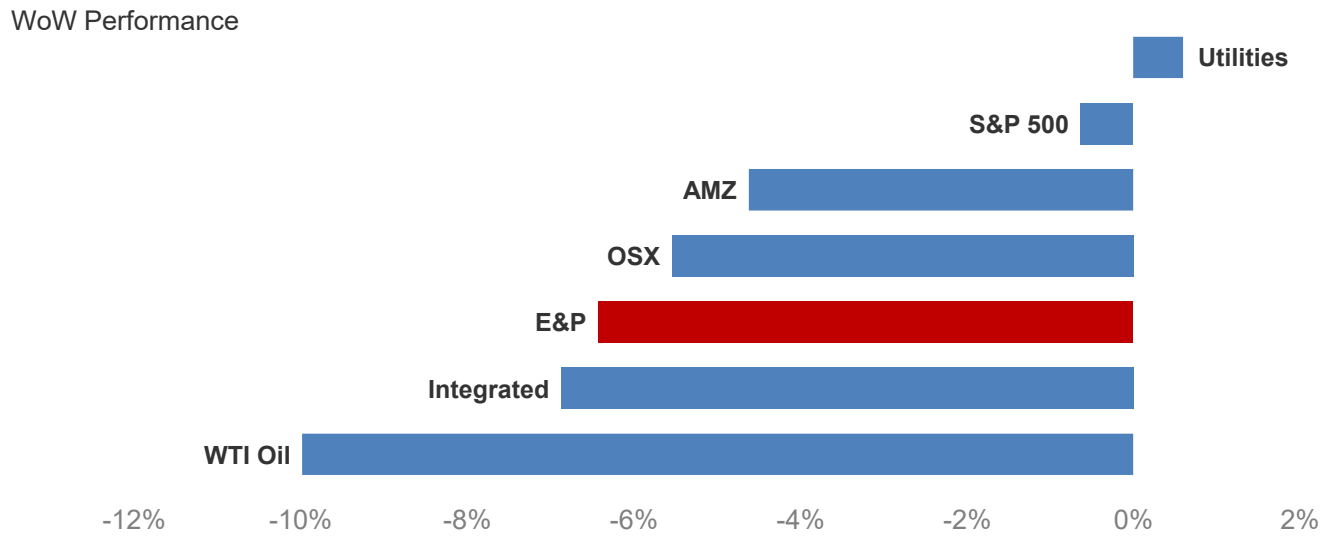
	Prior Base Dividend	New Base Dividend	Shareholder Returns	Debt Reduction
E&Ps				
AR	-	-	Repurchased 1.6 MM shares for $56 MM during the quarter. Expect to remain opportunistic during share price dislocations and weigh repurchases against debt repayment, M&A, and the commodity environment.	Expects debt to be down to pre-HG levels in coming quarters.
APA	$0.25/sh	$0.25/sh	In 3Q, returned $537 MM to shareholders, including $450 MM of share repurchases. In addition, repurchased an 4.5 MM shares at an average price of $47.32/sh in 4Q through October, bringing YTD repurchases to 17.8 MM shares. Committed to return at least 60% of 2026 FCF. Strong FCF outlook (~$2.9 B in 2026) supports substantial 4Q buybacks.	Lowered net debt target to $2 B from $3 B. Net debt of ~$3.2 B at 9/30, with the prior $3 B target expected by YE26 at strip
CHRD	$1.30/sh	$1.30/sh	In 3Q, repurchased 1.5 MM shares for $205 MM at an average price of $135.74/sh, with another $78 MM repurchased in 4Q as of 10/30 at an average price of $146.84/sh. Declared $1.30/sh base dividend. CHRD's leverage-based capital return framework calls for 75%+ FCF payout via base dividends and opportunistic buybacks at <0.5x (current), 50%+ FCF at <1.0x leverage, and the base dividend+ at >1.0x.	Targets <1.0x net leverage in a normalized price environment (~0.2x as of 9/30).
CNX	-	-	Repurchased 5.2 MM shares during 3Q at an average cost of $34.35/sh for a total cost of $180 MM.	Expects YE26 leverage ratio of 1.7x.
CRK	-	-	Suspended dividend in 2024 to preserve cash flow. We assume CRK restarts dividend in 2028 after debt reduction is achieved.	Net debt/LTM EBITDAX of 3.2x (up from 3.0x as of 2Q26 earnings) as CRK works to fund its production growth ramp. SOCAR cash should help pay off ~50% of debt outstanding.
COP	$0.84/sh	$0.93/sh	COP returned approximately 40% of CFO during 1H26 and maintained its full-year target of approximately 45%, implying a higher payout percentage during the second half of 2026. On the 3Q26 call, management messaged higher buybacks in 4Q vs 3Q.	
DVN	$0.32/sh	$0.32/sh	Plans >$1 B of buybacks in 4Q26 and further acceleration in 2027, supported by Eagle Ford proceeds, under its $8 B authorization through June 2029.	Targets ~$9 B of gross debt by 2027, with ~$1.5 B of remaining repayment funded by Eagle Ford proceeds.
FANG	$1.10/sh	$1.18/sh	In 3Q, repurchased 1.3 MM shares for ~$251 MM at an average price of $185.94/sh, and ~0.4 MM shares for ~$73 MM in 4Q to date. Raised quarterly base dividend 7.3% to $1.18/sh (~2.4% annualized yield as of 11/2). Expects to continue repurchases y using cash on hand, FCF, and potential asset sale proceeds.	Consolidated net debt of ~$12.8 B as of 9/30 (up from $12.3 B at 6/30 on higher Viper debt). FANG standalone net debt fell to ~$10.4 B as of 09/30 from ~$10.7 B as of 06/30. Previously disclosed consolidated net debt targets of $10 B near term and $6-8 B longer term.
EOG	$1.02/sh	$1.10/sh	In 3Q, paid $544 MM in regular dividends and repurchased 7.0 MM shares for $1.0 B at an average price of $143/sh, with $10.6 B remaining on authorization as of 09/30. Raised regular dividend 8% to $1.10/sh (~3% annualized yield as of 11/5). Committed to return at least 70% of annual FCF via growing regular dividend and opportunistic buybacks and special dividends.	Targets <1.0x debt-to-EBITDA at ~$45/bbl WTI and $2.50/mcf HH.
EXE	$0.575/sh	$0.575/sh	$1B remains under the authorization. Priorities remain sustaining capex, the base dividend, debt reduction, then buybacks or leasing.	Prioritizes further deleveraging following Twin Eagle while retaining opportunistic buyback flexibility. Net debt ~$4.7 B and leverage 0.8x at 9/30.
EQT	$0.165/sh	$0.17/sh	Management expects to invest in sustainable growth, y repurchase shares, and grow its base dividend.	Ended 3Q26 with $5.6 B of total debt and just under $5.5 B of net debt, approaching its $5 B maximum long-term debt target.
MTDR	$0.375/sh	$0.4375/sh	In 3Q, repurchased ~0.25 MM shares at an average price of ~$47.64/sh for a total of $12 MM.	Plans to repay $350-400 MM of borrowings by YE26, with $150 MM already repaid in October. Expects leverage to approach 1.5x by YE26.
MUR	$0.35/sh	$0.35/sh	MUR didn't repurchase any shares in 3Q; paid $50 MM in quarterly dividends. $550 MM remained under the share repurchase authorization as of 9/30. Targets to return at least 50% of adj. FCF through share buybacks and potential dividend increases.	Targeting a long-term debt of $1.0 B (Total debt of ~$1.63 B as of 9/30).
NOG	$0.45/sh	$0.45/sh	$0.45/sh quarterly dividend paid. Repurchased 667,989 shares of common stock at average price of $23.96/sh.	Exited 3Q26 with net debt/annualized adj. EBITDA of 1.47x. Has ability to achieve pro forma net debt/adj. EBITDA of <1.5x by year-end 2026.
OXY	$0.28/sh	$0.28/sh	Build cash for preferred equity redemption in August 2029. Opportunistic buybacks to resume once the balance sheet reaches a net-cash position.	Achieved $10 B milestone; established a new $6 B target. Maintain ~1x debt/EBITDA at $50 WTI long term.
OVV	$0.30/sh	$0.30/sh	Return 60%+ of FCF to shareholders in 2026; 50-100% beyond 2026	Expects <$4 B net debt post Logan close in 1Q27 (~$3.4 B at 9/30)
PR	$0.16/sh	$0.16/sh	Targets sustainable dividend growth and opportunistic buybacks during downturns or clear market dislocations.	Expects <0.5x net debt/EBITDAX by YE26 (0.5x at 9/30)
RRC	$0.10/sh	$0.10/sh	Excess FCF directed toward shareholder returns through a growing base dividend and opportunistic share repurchases	Maintain <1x Debt/EBITDAX at $3 Henry Hub (~0.6x as of 3Q26)
TOU	C$0.50/sh	C$0.525/sh	Repurchased 1.3 MM shares during 9/23-10/9; plans further 4Q purchases. Excess FCF supports base dividend growth, buybacks and potential special dividends.	Net debt of C$1.54 B at 9/30, below C$1.75 B long-term target
Integrateds				
CNQ	C$0.63/sh	C$0.63/sh	CNQ achieved its net debt target of C$13 B in 3Q26 and has now moved to allocating 100% of FCF to shareholders. The company also messaged repurchasing C$800 MM of shares per month beginning in November.	Targeting C$13 B net debt (C$12.12 B at 3Q26)
CVE	C$0.22/sh	C$0.22/sh	With 2Q26 results, CVE announced that they will begin allocating 75% of excess free funds flow (EFFF) to shareholder returns (up from 50%) since net debt is now below C$6 B. This allocation will move to 100% when net debt reaches C$4 B.	Targeting net debt floor of C$4 B. Net debt as of 3Q26 is C$3.0 B, though CVE previously guided to C$5.0-C$5.5 B of pro forma net debt for YE26 following the closing of the ATH acquisition.
CVX	$1.78/sh	$1.78/sh	Expects 4Q buybacks of $2.5 - $3.0 B, in-line with 3Q guidance. CVX aims to repurchase $10 - $20 B of shares within a Brent oil price range of $60 - $80.	Targets 20-25% net debt ratio through the cycle. With 2Q26 results, CVX reported net debt to CFFO of 0.4X
IMO	C$0.87/sh	C$0.87/sh	Returns surplus cash through NCIB and SIB. As of the 3Q26 earnings release, IMO remains on track to complete its accelerated NCIB by the end of this year. Management messaged that the company is well positioned to return additional surplus cash to shareholders in the new year, implying a potential SIB tender announcement in 1Q27.	
SU	C$0.60/sh	C$0.66/sh	At the beginning of October, SU announced plans to repurchase C$750 MM of shares per month, up from the prior amount of C$500 MM.	Has goal to maintain a 1X net debt to AFFO ratio (at US$50 WTI), equating to ~C$10 B of net debt. As of 3Q26, net debt stood at ~C$1.75 B.
XOM	$1.03/sh	$1.07/sh	Expects ~$20 B of annual buybacks in 2026. With 3Q26 earnings release, XOM announced ~$20 B of buybacks in 2027.	
Royalties & Minerals				
VNOM	$0.50/sh	$0.50/sh	In 3Q, declared a $0.50/sh base dividend (no variable dividend) and repurchased ~2.1 MM Class A shares for ~$90 MM at an average price of $43.01/sh. Repurchased an additional ~0.4 MM shares for ~$17 MM in 4Q to date, with ~$906 MM remaining on the buyback authorization as of 10/30.	Previously disclosed net debt target of $1.5 B. Net debt of ~$2.4 B as of 9/30 (up from ~$1.6 B at 6/30) following 3Q acquisitions.

Source: Company disclosure, Morgan Stanley Research

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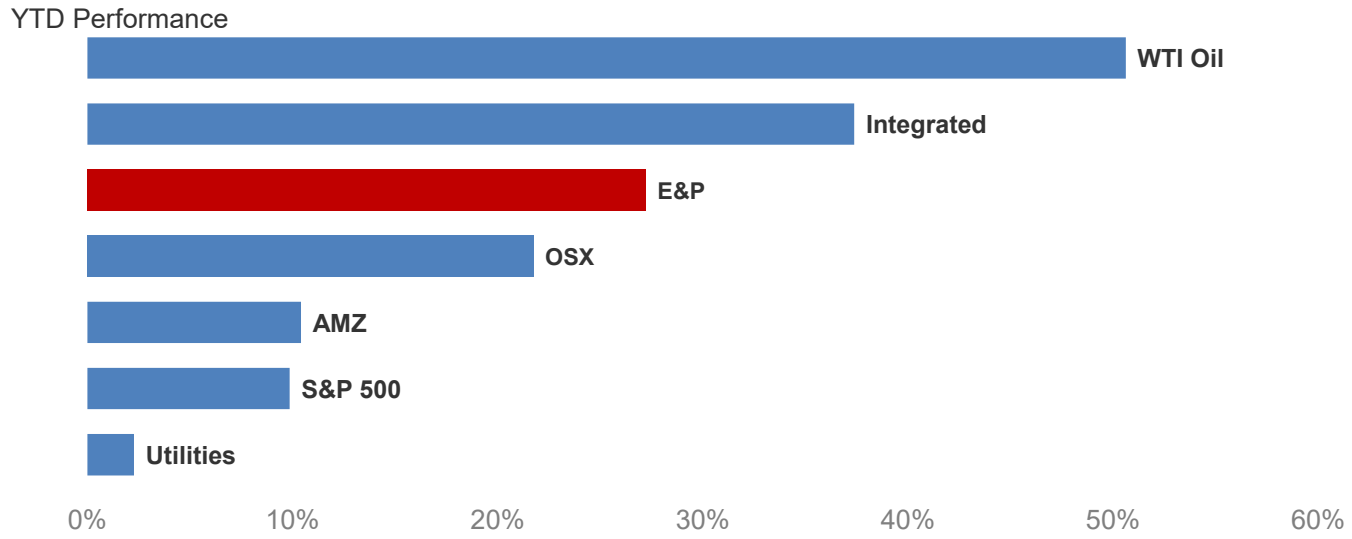
Performance & Key Industry Metrics

Exhibit 8: WoW Energy Sub-sector Performance



Source: Bloomberg, FactSet, Morgan Stanley Research

Exhibit 9: YTD Energy Sub-sector Performance

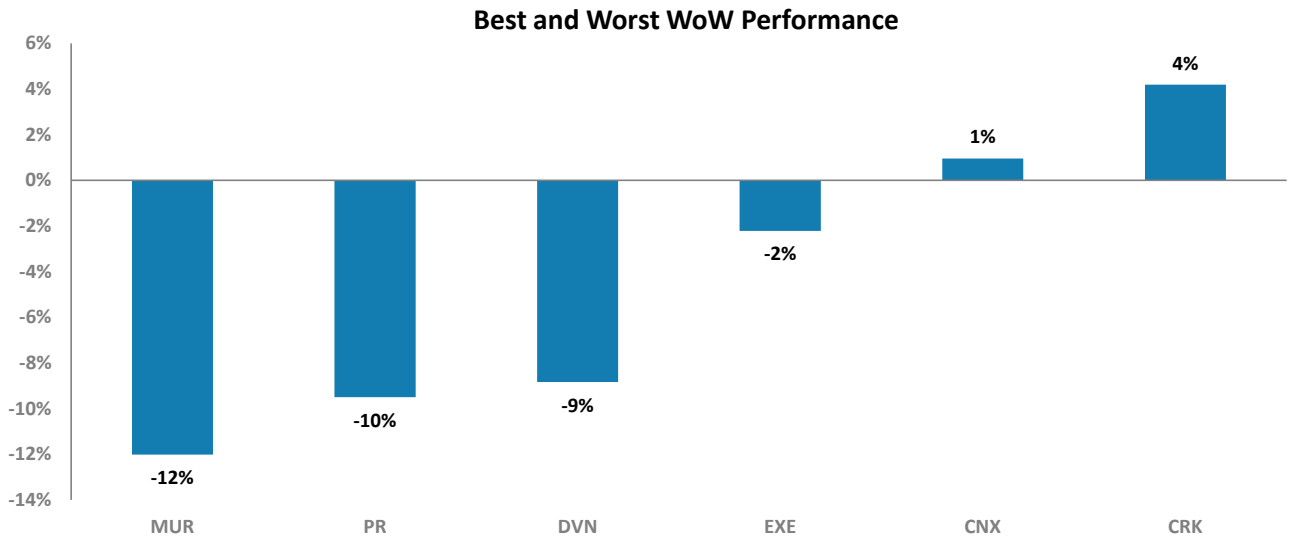


Source: Bloomberg, FactSet, Morgan Stanley Research

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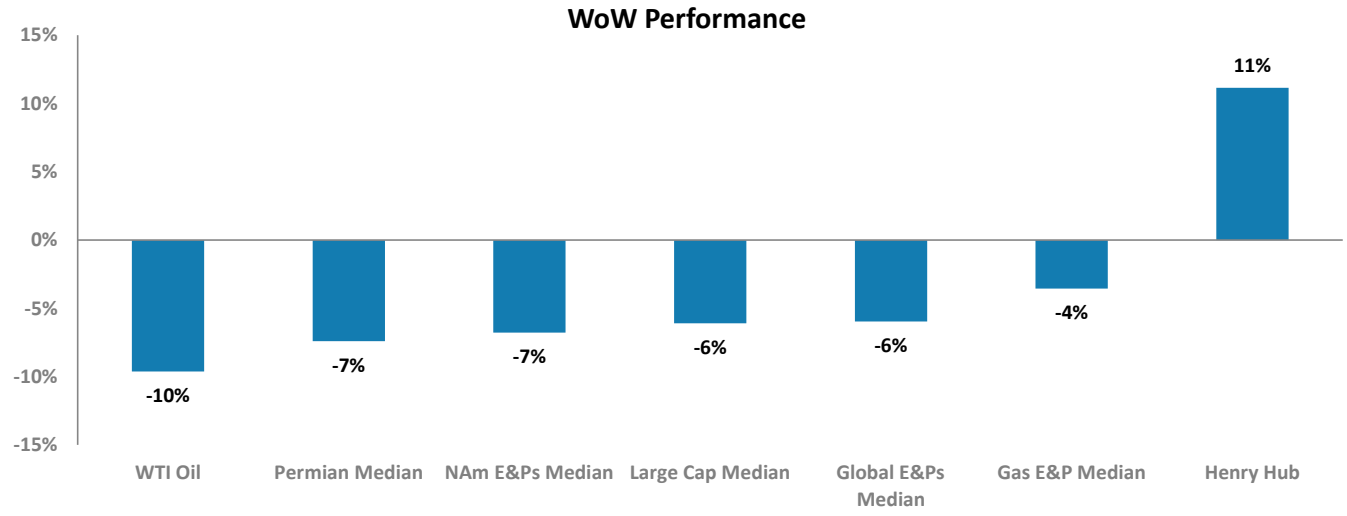
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Exhibit 10: Best and Worst E&P WoW Performance



Source: FactSet, Morgan Stanley Research

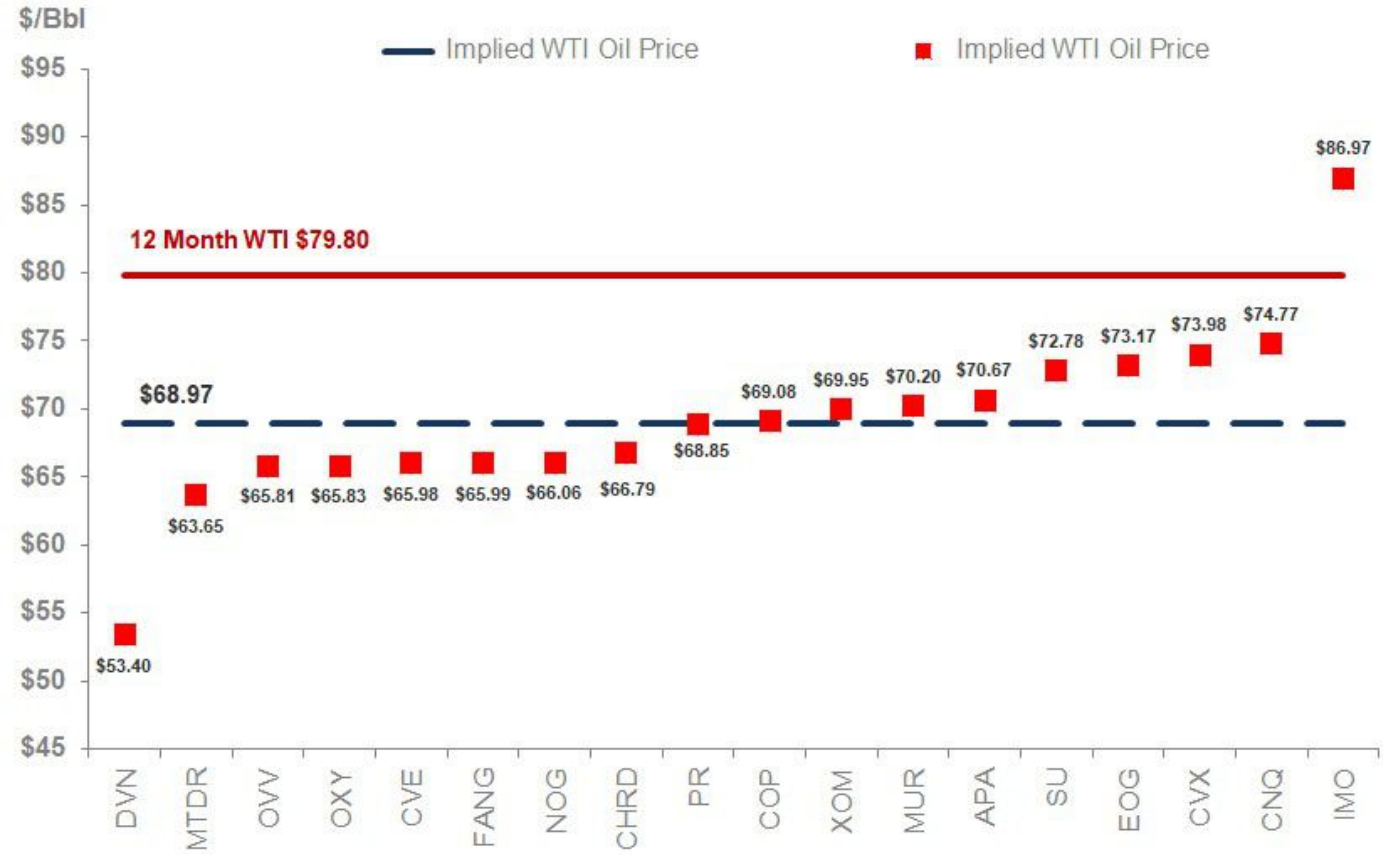
Exhibit 11: WoW Performance by E&P Sub-sector



Source: FactSet, Morgan Stanley Research

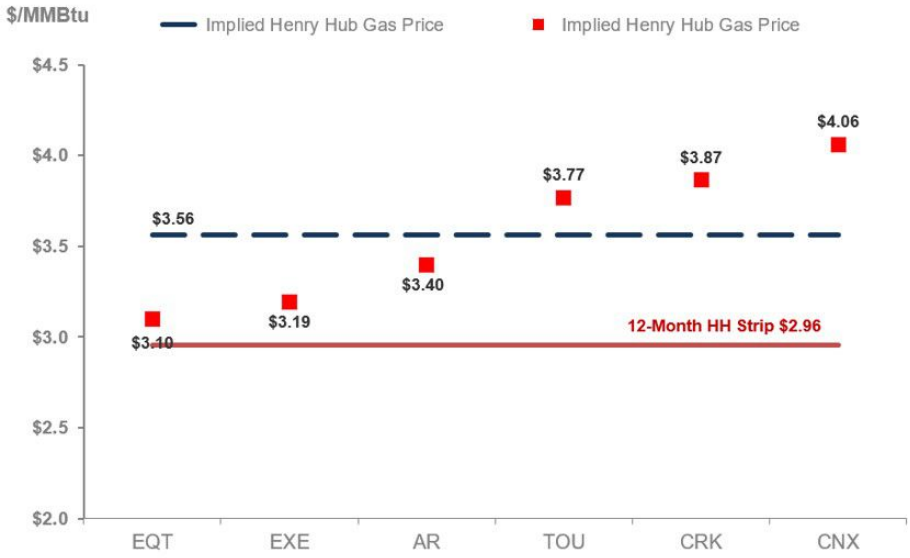
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Exhibit 12: Oil E&Ps reflect long-run WTI price of ~$69/bbl, ~14% below the 12-month strip price.



Source: Bloomberg, Morgan Stanley Research estimates. Note: prices as of 11.10.26 close.

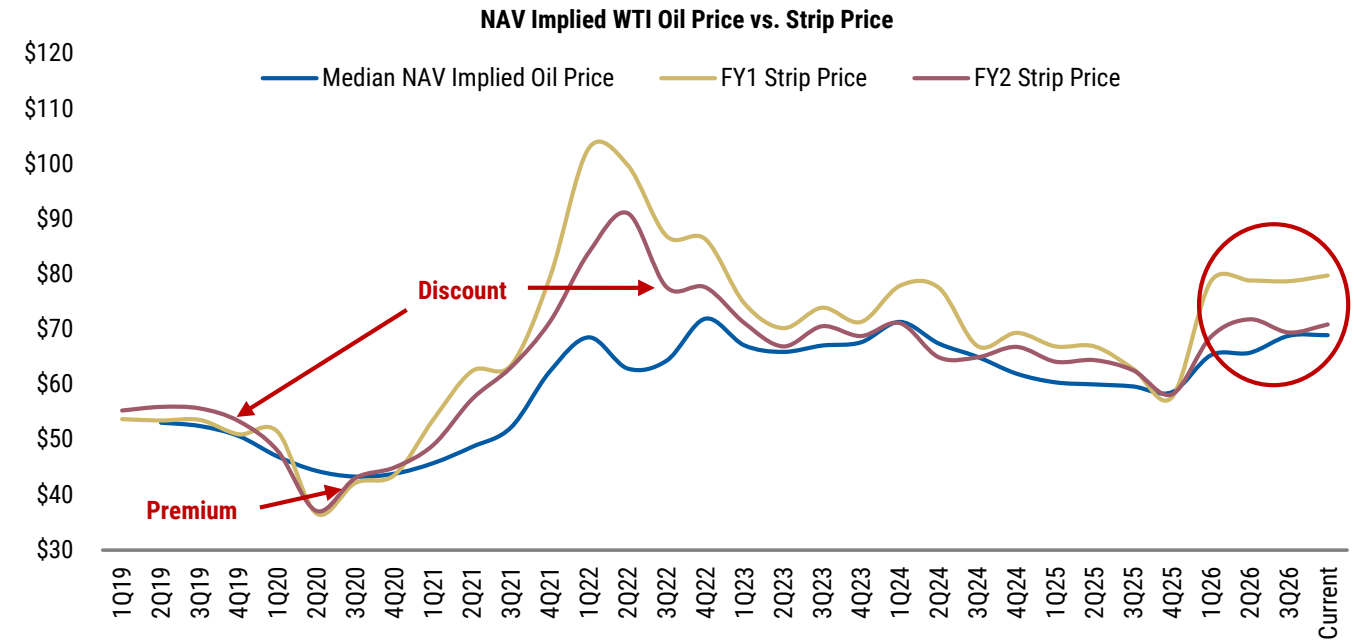
Exhibit 13: Gas E&Ps reflect Henry Hub price of $3.56, above the 12-month strip but below our $3.75 long-run estimate.



Source: Bloomberg, Morgan Stanley Research estimates. Note: prices as of 11.10.26 close.

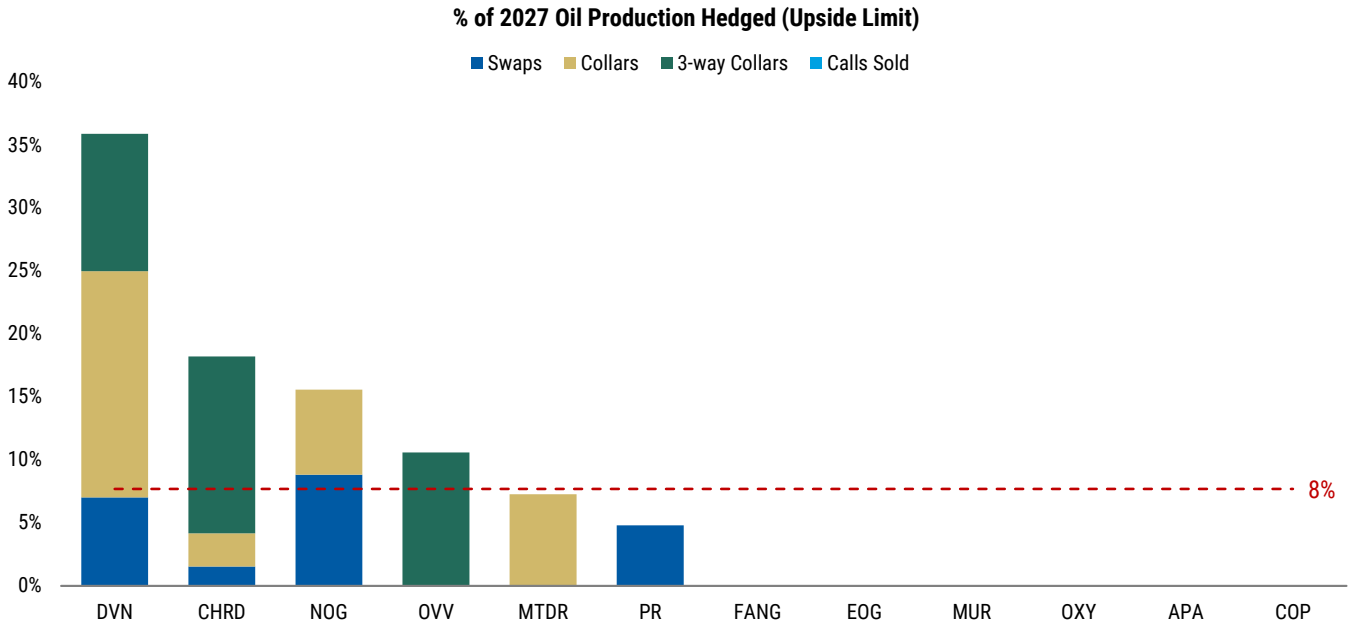
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Exhibit 14: NAV implied oil prices in our coverage now sit ~14% below the 12-month strip price.



Source: Company Reports, Bloomberg, Morgan Stanley Research estimates

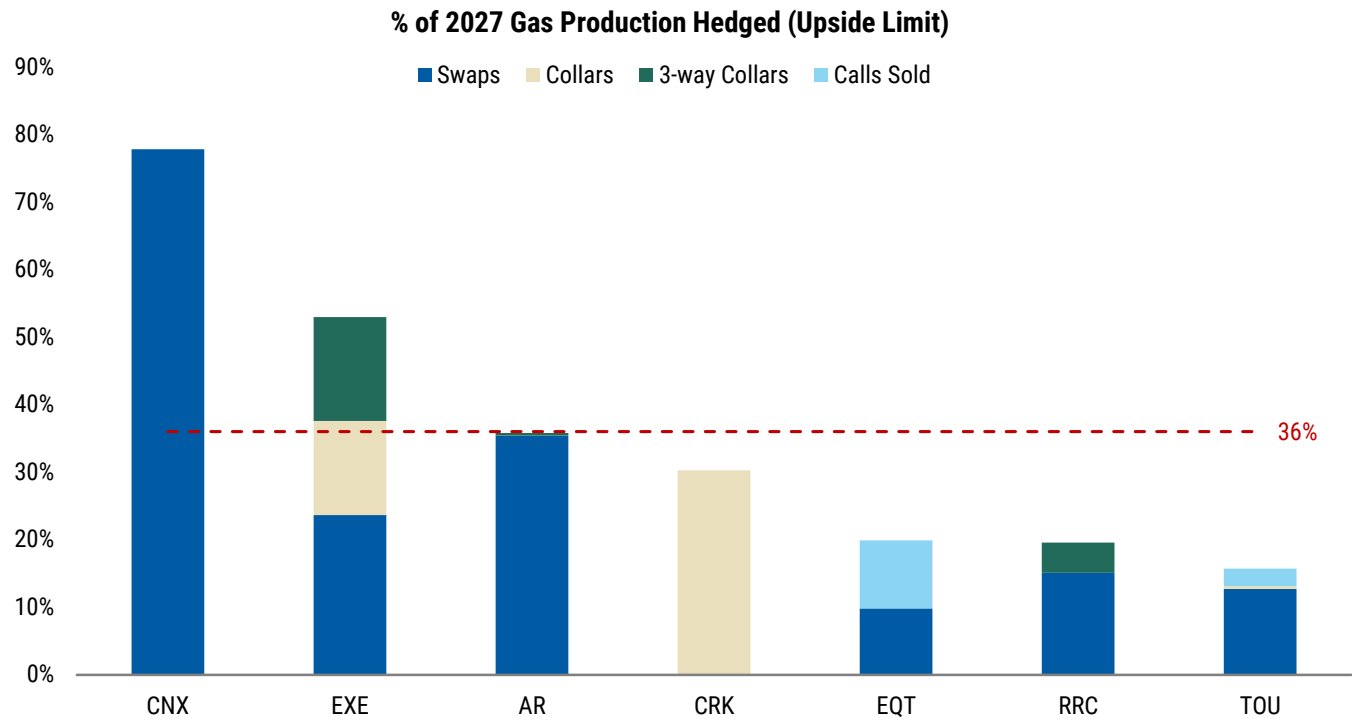
Exhibit 15: Our oil coverage has an average of ~8% of 2027 production hedged.



Source: Company Data, Morgan Stanley Research estimates. These figures do not fully reflect hedges disclosed with 3Q26 earnings.

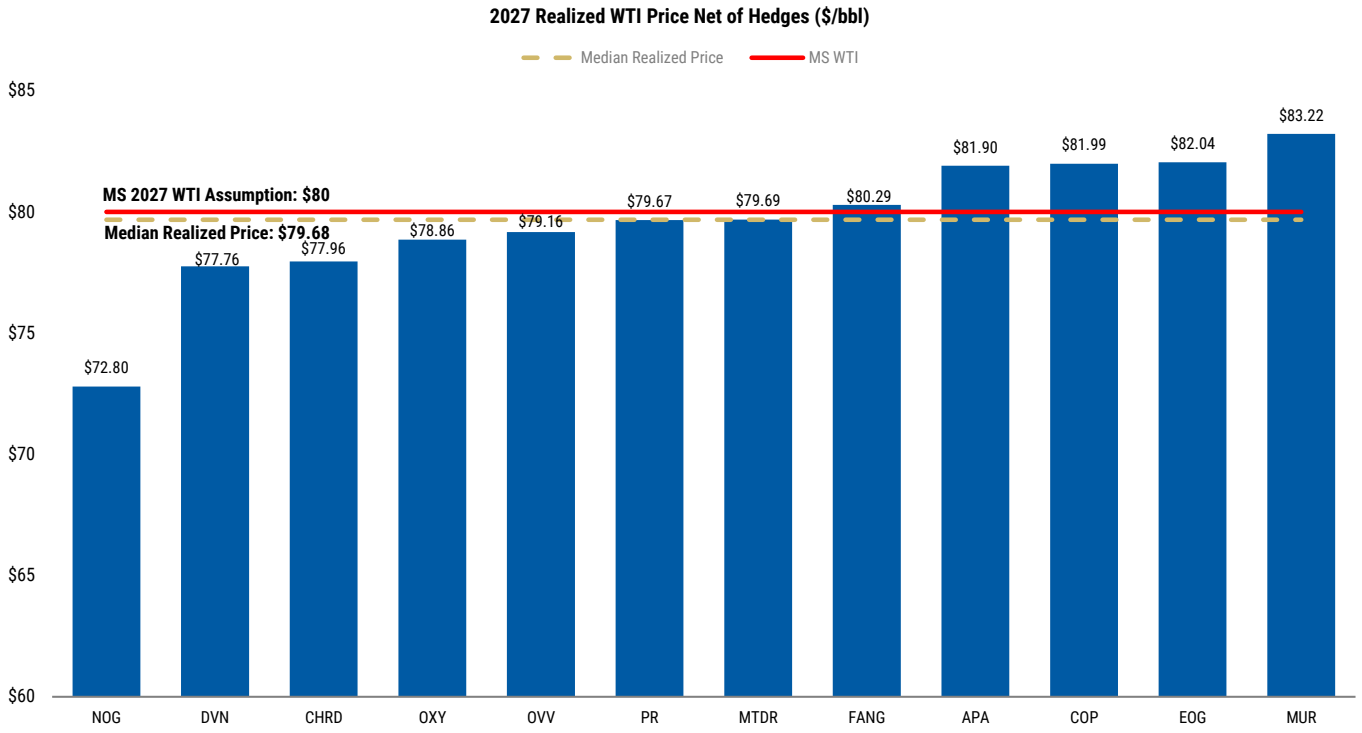
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Exhibit 16: Gas E&Ps have hedged ~35% of estimated 2027 production on average.



Source: Company Data, Morgan Stanley Research estimates

Exhibit 17: At $80 WTI in 2027, we forecast median realized oil prices of ~$80/bbl across our coverage, with geographic mix and hedging driving differences.



mpany Reports, Morgan Stanley Research estimates

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Comps

Exhibit 18: Comp Sheet

Commodity Benchmark Prices	2026E	2027E	2028E
WTI Cushing Oil ($/Bbl)	84.99	80.10	70.00
WCS ($/Bbl)	64.72	60.97	55.00
Brent Oil ($/Bbl)	95.23	87.63	75.00
US Henry Hub ($/MMBtu)	3.55	3.20	3.75
Mont Belvieu NGL ($/Bbl)	31.18	30.39	25.80
GC 321 Brent ($/Bbl)	36.10	36.00	16.20

				Market			EV/EBITDAX			EV/ Debt-Adjusted Cash Flow			FCF yield (Pre-Div)			Total Yield (Dividends + Buybacks)			Net Debt/ EBITDAX			Prod Growth YoY		
Company	Ticker	Rating	Price 11/10/26	Cap ($MM)	Price Target	PT Upside	2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E
US Majors																								
Chevron Corp.	CVX	OW	$211.22	417,178	$230	9%	6.4x	5.8x	7.5x	7.3x	6.9x	8.5x	11%	10%	7%	6%	6%	7%	0.2x	0.0x	0.0x	7%	5%	1%
Exxon Mobil Corporation	XOM	OW	$164.47	686,498	$187	14%	7.0x	5.7x	6.6x	8.3x	7.0x	7.9x	8%	10%	7%	5%	5%	6%	0.1x	-0.1x	-0.3x	-4%	9%	4%
US Majors Median						**11%**	**6.7x**	**5.7x**	**7.0x**	**7.8x**	**6.9x**	**8.2x**	**10%**	**10%**	**7%**	**6%**	**6%**	**6%**	**0.2x**	**-0.1x**	**-0.1x**	**1%**	**7%**	**3%**
Canada																								
Canadian Natural Resources Ltd	CNQ	EW	C$68.40	C$142,945	C$74	8%	6.2x	5.8x	6.4x	6.8x	6.8x	7.5x	9%	9%	7%	7%	9%	7%	0.5x	0.5x	0.6x	6%	3%	1%
Cenovus Energy Inc	CVE	OW	C$39.33	C$73,594	C$51	30%	3.8x	3.9x	4.3x	4.3x	4.6x	5.0x	16%	13%	10%	9%	13%	10%	0.1x	0.2x	0.3x	20%	3%	4%
Imperial Oil Ltd	IMO	EW	C$174.99	C$84,853	C$151	-14%	6.8x	6.2x	8.0x	8.6x	7.7x	9.7x	9%	10%	7%	7%	9%	7%	0.1x	0.1x	0.1x	-0%	4%	3%
Suncor Energy Inc	SU	OW	C$96.12	C$113,325	C$112	17%	4.0x	3.8x	5.1x	4.9x	4.7x	6.0x	14%	13%	8%	7%	10%	8%	0.0x	-0.2x	-0.3x	-1%	2%	7%
Canada Median						**12%**	**5.1x**	**4.8x**	**5.8x**	**5.8x**	**5.7x**	**6.7x**	**12%**	**11%**	**8%**	**7%**	**10%**	**8%**	**0.1x**	**0.1x**	**0.2x**	**3%**	**3%**	**4%**
Oil E&Ps																								
APA Corp.	APA	UW	$45.12	15,972	$43	-5%	2.8x	3.0x	3.5x	3.5x	3.5x	4.0x	15%	10%	6%	9%	6%	4%	0.5x	0.4x	0.4x	-7%	1%	2%
Chord Energy Corp.	CHRD	OW	$138.62	7,847	$178	28%	2.2x	2.2x	2.4x	2.3x	2.3x	2.7x	21%	15%	10%	13%	11%	8%	0.0x	-0.1x	-0.2x	2%	-6%	0%
ConocoPhillips	COP	OW	$135.59	164,641	$159	17%	5.0x	4.6x	4.9x	6.3x	6.0x	6.1x	9%	9%	8%	7%	7%	7%	0.4x	0.3x	0.3x	-3%	5%	2%
Devon Energy Corp.	DVN	OW	$43.41	48,382	$64	47%	4.0x	3.3x	3.1x	4.5x	3.7x	3.5x	14%	15%	13%	6%	11%	10%	0.5x	0.4x	0.3x	65%	16%	0%
Diamondback Energy, Inc.	FANG	EW	$178.08	50,045	$222	25%	4.5x	4.4x	4.8x	5.3x	5.0x	5.4x	14%	13%	10%	5%	6%	9%	0.7x	0.4x	0.4x	9%	2%	2%
EOG Resources Inc.	EOG	EW	$151.51	80,149	$163	8%	4.6x	4.6x	5.1x	5.5x	5.3x	5.8x	10%	10%	8%	7%	8%	8%	0.1x	0.0x	0.0x	14%	3%	3%
Matador Resources Co.	MTDR	EW	$50.34	6,250	$69	37%	4.3x	3.4x	3.5x	4.8x	4.0x	4.1x	14%	17%	14%	3%	3%	3%	1.9x	1.3x	1.2x	8%	9%	5%
Murphy Oil Corp.	MUR	UW	$34.72	5,074	$37	7%	2.7x	2.9x	3.0x	2.8x	3.2x	3.3x	9%	1%	6%	4%	4%	5%	0.4x	0.5x	0.5x	-5%	6%	5%
Northern Oil and Gas, Inc	NOG	UW	$23.41	2,530	$26	11%	3.2x	3.1x	3.3x	4.1x	3.9x	4.5x	19%	14%	9%	7%	10%	8%	1.6x	1.5x	1.7x	9%	2%	0%
Occidental Petroleum Corp.	OXY	EW	$56.90	57,594	$70	23%	4.4x	4.4x	4.5x	4.8x	5.0x	5.0x	15%	13%	11%	2%	7%	2%	0.9x	0.7x	0.5x	-0%	1%	1%
Ovintiv Inc	OVV	EW	$61.60	17,365	$71	15%	3.7x	3.5x	3.6x	3.7x	3.5x	3.9x	15%	14%	9%	9%	9%	7%	0.5x	0.5x	0.5x	2%	1%	0%
Permian Resources Corp.	PR	OW	$21.72	18,576	$27	24%	3.7x	3.0x	3.0x	4.1x	3.7x	3.7x	17%	16%	13%	3%	3%	3%	0.3x	-0.2x	-0.5x	6%	5%	2%
Oil E&Ps Median						**20%**	**3.9x**	**3.4x**	**3.5x**	**4.3x**	**3.8x**	**4.0x**	**15%**	**14%**	**10%**	**7%**	**7%**	**7%**	**0.5x**	**0.4x**	**0.4x**	**4%**	**2%**	**2%**
Gas E&Ps																								
Antero Resources Corp.	AR	OW	$37.63	11,689	$51	36%	5.0x	3.8x	3.1x	6.0x	4.4x	3.8x	10%	15%	14%	1%	5%	4%	0.9x	0.4x	0.1x	20%	10%	4%
CNX Resources Corp.	CNX	UW	$36.93	5,686	$34	-8%	5.6x	5.1x	4.3x	6.7x	5.7x	5.2x	9%	10%	11%	9%	7%	4%	1.3x	1.3x	1.1x	-2%	-1%	-1%
Comstock Resources Inc.	CRK	EW	$14.42	4,205	$13	-10%	5.9x	6.6x	5.7x	6.9x	9.2x	7.6x	-10%	-12%	-4%	0%	0%	1%	1.4x	1.9x	1.8x	4%	3%	-1%
EQT Corp.	EQT	OW	$52.00	32,711	$67	29%	6.3x	6.1x	4.2x	6.5x	6.0x	4.6x	11%	11%	14%	1%	3%	3%	0.8x	0.4x	-0.1x	2%	2%	6%
Expand Energy Corp.	EXE	OW	$87.94	20,014	$123	40%	4.3x	4.1x	3.4x	4.3x	4.3x	3.7x	13%	11%	13%	9%	8%	9%	0.7x	0.7x	0.5x	5%	1%	2%
Range Resources Corp.	RRC	EW	$51.20	12,094	$45	-12%	7.5x	7.4x	6.4x	7.8x	8.2x	7.7x	7%	6%	6%	3%	3%	5%	0.4x	0.2x	0.1x	6%	11%	2%
Tourmaline Oil Corp.	TOU	EW	C$63.93	C$24,931	C$68	6%	6.6x	5.3x	5.2x	6.6x	5.3x	5.5x	4%	8%	8%	4%	4%	4%	0.3x	0.0x	-0.2x	-2%	6%	3%
Gas E&Ps Median						**6%**	**5.9x**	**5.3x**	**4.3x**	**6.6x**	**5.7x**	**5.2x**	**9%**	**10%**	**11%**	**3%**	**4%**	**4%**	**0.8x**	**0.4x**	**0.1x**	**4%**	**3%**	**2%**
Royalties & Minerals																								
Viper Energy, Inc.	VNOM	OW	$40.19	14,679	$47	17%	9.3x	9.0x	9.1x	10.4x	10.0x	10.0x	13%	13%	13%	6%	9%	8%	0.8x	0.5x	0.3x	41%	4%	4%
Total Coverage Median						**15%**	**4.6x**	**4.4x**	**4.4x**	**5.4x**	**5.0x**	**5.1x**	**12%**	**11%**	**9%**	**6%**	**7%**	**7%**	**0.5x**	**0.4x**	**0.3x**	**5%**	**3%**	**2%**

Source: FactSet, Morgan Stanley Research estimates

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(as of October 31, 2026)

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	Coverage Universe		Investment Banking Clients (IBC)			Other Material Investment Services Clients (MISC)	
Stock Rating Category	Count	% of Total	Count	% of Total IBC	% of Rating Category	Count	% of Total Other MISC
Overweight/Buy	1575	43%	460	49%	29%	742	44%
Equal-weight/Hold	1537	42%	393	42%	26%	720	43%
Not-Rated/Hold	2	0%	1	0%	50%	1	0%
Underweight/Sell	570	15%	92	10%	16%	218	13%
Total	3,684		946			1681	

Data include common stock and ADRs currently assigned ratings. Investment Banking Clients are companies from whom Morgan Stanley received investment banking compensation in the last 12 months. Due to rounding off of decimals, the percentages provided in the "% of total" column may not add up to exactly 100 percent.

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Overweight (O). The stock's total return is expected to exceed the average total return of the analyst's industry (or industry team's) coverage universe, on a risk-adjusted basis, over the next 12-18 months.

Equal-weight (E). The stock's total return is expected to be in line with the average total return of the analyst's industry (or industry team's) coverage universe, on a risk-adjusted basis, over the next 12-18 months.

Not-Rated (NR). Currently the analyst does not have adequate conviction about the stock's total return relative to the average total return of the analyst's industry (or industry team's) coverage universe, on a risk-adjusted basis, over the next 12-18 months.

Underweight (U). The stock's total return is expected to be below the average total return of the analyst's industry (or industry team's) coverage universe, on a risk-adjusted basis, over the next 12-18 months.

Unless otherwise specified, the time frame for price targets included in Morgan Stanley Research is 12 to 18 months.

Analyst Industry Views

Attractive (A): The analyst expects the performance of his or her industry coverage universe over the next 12-18 months to be attractive vs. the relevant broad market benchmark, as indicated below.

In-Line (I): The analyst expects the performance of his or her industry coverage universe over the next 12-18 months to be in line with the relevant broad market benchmark, as indicated below.

Cautious (C): The analyst views the performance of his or her industry coverage universe over the next 12-18 months with caution vs. the relevant broad market benchmark, as indicated below.

Benchmarks for each region are as follows: North America - S&P 500; Latin America - relevant MSCI country index or MSCI Latin America Index; Europe - MSCI Europe; Japan - TOPIX; Asia - relevant MSCI country index or MSCI sub-regional index or MSCI AC Asia Pacific ex Japan Index.

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INDUSTRY COVERAGE: Exploration & Production

COMPANY (TICKER)	RATING (AS OF)	PRICE* (11/10/2026)
Devin McDermott		
Antero Resources Corp (AR.N)	O (04/17/2024)	$37.63
APA Corp (APA.O)	U (04/15/2024)	$45.12
Chord Energy Corporation (CHRD.O)	O (03/27/2026)	$138.62
CNX Resources Corp (CNX.N)	U (01/10/2025)	$36.93
Comstock Resources Inc. (CRK.N)	E (01/10/2025)	$14.42
ConocoPhillips (COP.N)	O (12/16/2024)	$135.59
Devon Energy Corp (DVN.N)	O (12/11/2023)	$43.41
Diamondback Energy Inc (FANG.O)	E (08/19/2026)	$178.08
EOG Resources Inc (EOG.N)	E (12/11/2023)	$151.51
EQT Corp. (EQT.N)	O (11/18/2021)	$52.00
Expand Energy Corp (EXE.O)	O (01/10/2025)	$87.94
Matador Resources Co (MTDR.N)	E (01/10/2025)	$50.34

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Murphy Oil Corporation (MUR.N)	U (01/22/2025)	$34.72
Northern Oil & Gas Inc. (NOG.N)	U (08/18/2025)	$23.41
Occidental Petroleum Corp (OXY.N)	E (08/18/2025)	$56.90
Ovintiv Inc (OVV.N)	E (03/27/2026)	$61.60
Permian Resources Corp (PR.N)	O (01/10/2025)	$21.72
Range Resources Corp. (RRC.N)	E (03/26/2025)	$51.20
Tourmaline Oil Corp. (TOU.TO)	E (01/10/2025)	C$63.93
Viper Energy Inc (VNOM.O)	O (08/18/2025)	$40.19

Stock Ratings are subject to change. Please see latest research for each company.
* Historical prices are not split adjusted.

INDUSTRY COVERAGE: Integrated Energy

COMPANY (TICKER)	RATING (AS OF)	PRICE* (11/10/2026)
Devin McDermott		
Canadian Natural Resources Ltd (CNQ.TO)	E (10/07/2021)	C$68.40
Cenovus Energy (CVE.TO)	O (10/07/2021)	C$39.33
Chevron Corporation (CVX.N)	O (08/04/2025)	$211.22
Exxon Mobil Corporation (XOM.N)	O (05/14/2024)	$164.47
Imperial Oil Ltd (IMO.TO)	E (10/07/2021)	C$174.99
Suncor Energy Inc (SU.TO)	O (08/19/2026)	C$96.12

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